

Neysha Pagán Vargas

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Professional Summary

Strategic and solutions-driven Data & Analytics Leader with 14+ years of experience designing and scaling enterprise data platforms that enable business transformation and AI adoption. Proven track record leading cross-functional teams across engineering, BI, and data science to deliver governed, enterprise-scale Lakehouse ecosystems in Azure environments. Experienced in aligning data architecture, governance frameworks, and AI-driven automation initiatives with executive objectives. Adept at translating complex business requirements into scalable data strategies that optimize cost, performance, and organizational productivity while ensuring compliance, reliability, and measurable value realization.

Core Skills & Technologies

- **Enterprise Data & AI Strategy:** Data monetization, AI adoption roadmap, operating model design, data-driven transformation initiatives aligned to executive objectives.
- **Data Governance & Risk Management:** Enterprise governance frameworks (DAMA-aligned), data quality programs, compliance oversight, security architecture, ethical AI controls.
- **AI & Advanced Analytics Enablement:** AI integration strategy, NLP & intelligent automation use cases, semantic modeling governance, scalable analytics platforms.
- **Enterprise Data Architecture:** Lakehouse strategy, modern cloud data platforms (Azure/AWS), HA/DR strategy, RPO/RTO planning, scalable integration architecture.
- **Cloud & Platform Modernization:** Azure & multi-cloud strategy, Infrastructure-as-Code, DevOps governance, platform cost optimization & capacity planning.
- **Executive Stakeholder Leadership:** Board-level communication, cross-functional alignment, portfolio prioritization, KPI definition, value realization tracking.
- **Data Culture & Organizational Enablement:** Analytics democratization, data literacy programs, role-based access strategy (Entra ID / RBAC), licensing governance, cross-functional collaboration between Data Engineering, BI, and Data Science.

Certifications

- **Microsoft Certified:** Azure Database Administrator Associate | Azure Fundamentals | Azure Data Fundamentals | Administering a SQL Database Infrastructure | MTA: Database Fundamentals
- **Others:** SAFe 5.0 Agilist | Profisee Master Data Architect & Master Data System Administrator | IBM Big Data Technologies | Microsoft AI & Data Science

Professional Experience

StayTerra Vacations – Bradenton, FL

Manager Analytics and Reporting - Enterprise Data & Analytics Leadership | Sept 2025 - Present

- Defined and operationalized StayTerra's Enterprise Data Strategy and Governance Roadmap, transitioning the organization from siloed MySQL-based reporting processes to a governed, multi-entity Azure Lakehouse platform supporting analytics, BI, and future data science workloads.
- Architected and scaled a centralized Azure Data Platform from **4 initial brands/entities to 7**, representing a **75% increase in supported platform scale**, while maintaining a unified governance, security, and identity model using Entra ID, RBAC, Managed Identities, and Service Principals.
- Designed and implemented a metadata-driven Medallion Architecture across Bronze, Silver, and Gold layers with built-in data quality controls, lineage, traceability, watermark logic, schema validation, and run-level auditability.
- Reduced daily cloud platform spend by approximately **47.8%** through Databricks and Fabric optimization, workload scheduling improvements, pipeline tuning, capacity analysis, and compute governance.
- Improved data pipeline performance by reducing processing duration by up to **87%** for one major business unit and approximately **85%** for another, strengthening platform reliability, refresh stability, and downstream reporting readiness.

- Led enterprise access, licensing, and role-based governance across Microsoft Fabric, Power BI, Azure Databricks, and related data services, aligning executive, analyst, engineering, and data science users with least-privilege access and cost-conscious workspace design.
- Partnered with Data Analysts, Data Scientists, and business stakeholders to enable governed semantic models, certified reporting workspaces, self-service BI, and advanced analytics environments aligned to enterprise KPI standards.
- Directed capacity planning and workload optimization across Microsoft Fabric and Azure Databricks, including SKU evaluation, concurrency management, workload isolation, semantic model refresh alignment, and performance degradation mitigation.
- Oversaw DevOps-oriented data lifecycle management, including environment segregation across development, test, and production layers, CI/CD alignment, Git-based delivery practices, and scalable deployment governance for enterprise analytics assets.

Universal North America – Sarasota, FL

Database Architect | Nov 2024 – Present

- Led enterprise-wide data governance initiative, integrating compliance, operational visibility, and security into a unified data strategy.
- Architected high-availability SQL Server clusters across multiple datacenters using Always On Availability Groups.
- Conducted strategic planning and feasibility assessment for a potential Azure migration, performing risk analysis, dependency mapping, and evaluation of cloud deployment models.
- Developed automated PowerShell and T-SQL scripts for health checks, index monitoring, and OS audits, with PoC integration of AI-based techniques for future pipeline optimization.
- Optimized configuration settings (MAXDOP, tempdb, file growth) and delivered index optimization plans, eliminating high-maintenance indexes.
- Created executive-level documentation for RPO/RTO targets, replication strategies, and operational governance frameworks.
- Achieved a 25% improvement in database performance through optimized configurations and targeted index maintenance.

Deloitte – FL / Remote

Manager Solutions Architecture / Lead DevOps Engineer | Oct 2022 – May 2025

- Architected and implemented a Medallion (Bronze/Silver/Gold) Lakehouse architecture in Azure Databricks & Delta Lake, unifying 15+ disparate data sources into a centralized platform, reducing reporting latency from 24 hours to under 2 hours, and implementing SCD Type 2 for historical tracking.
- Led ingestion and optimization initiatives across Azure Data Factory, PySpark, and SQL Server, embedding automated data quality controls, eliminating redundant data at scale, improving query performance by 40%, and producing governance-aligned documentation to meet enterprise cloud standards.

Neudesic – NY / Remote

Senior Consultant I – Data & AI | Mar 2022 – Oct 2022

- Delivered enterprise-grade Power BI solutions, designing tabular models, advanced DAX measures, and scenario-based KPIs, while optimizing Azure Synapse pipelines and dimensional models to enhance BI performance and scalability.
- Contributed to Data Governance initiatives, including evaluation of Microsoft Purview integration, and provided cross-functional leadership through mentoring junior developers and facilitating regional collaboration across distributed teams.

Education

- CDAIO (*Chief Data & AI Officer*) Program, Carnegie Mellon, PA (*expected completion date: July 2026*)
- M.S. Applied Data Science, Syracuse University, NY
- B.S. Computer Information Systems, University of Puerto Rico at Mayagüez

Languages

- English (Fluent) | Spanish (Fluent)

Additional Experiences (*details available upon request*): GEE0 | Dude Solutions | Deloitte Services LP | DXC Technology | Molina Healthcare | Eastern Consulting Group | Puerto Rico Highway & Transportation Authority